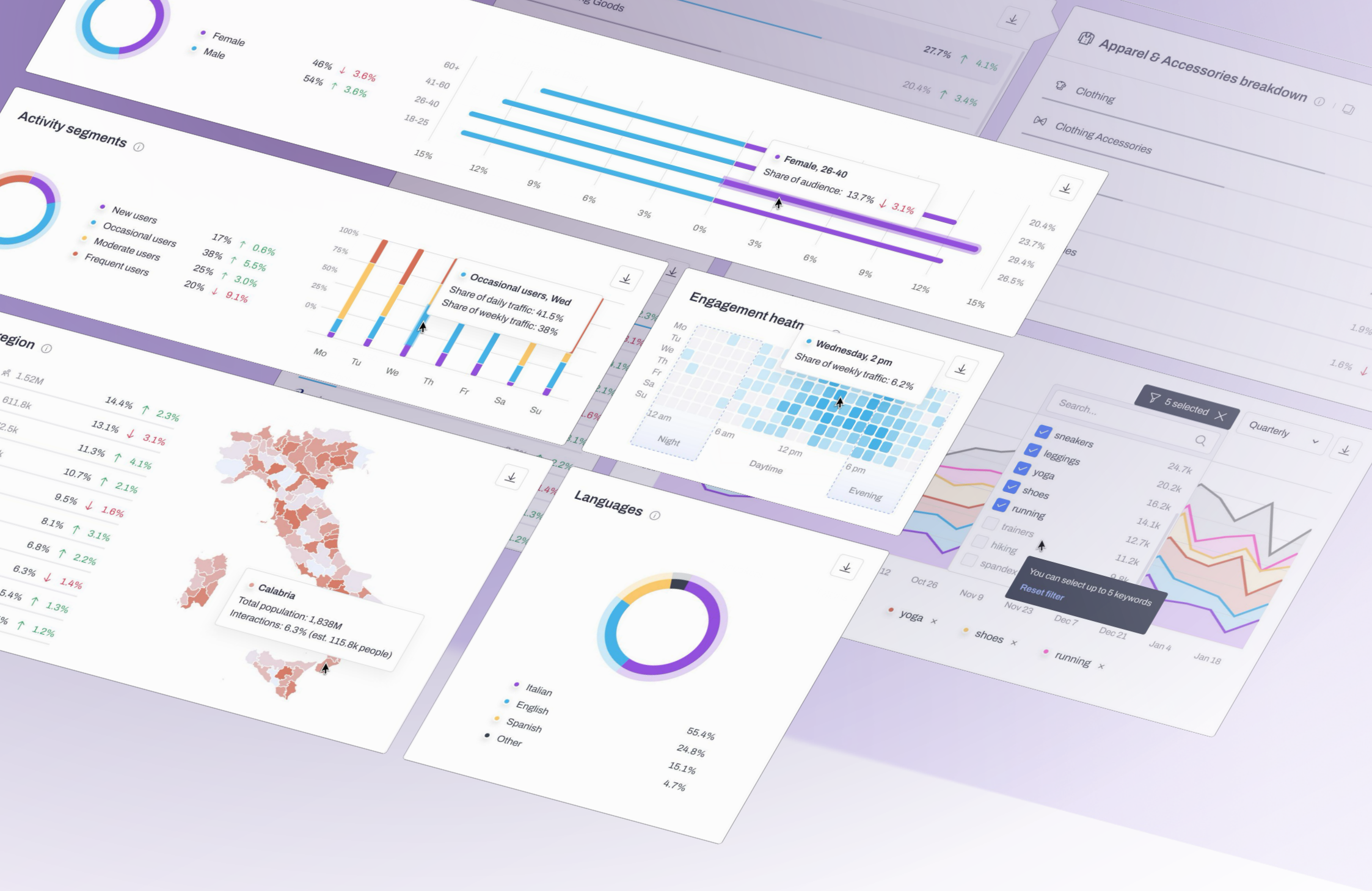




portfolio



AdClarity Marketing Intelligence

AdClarity is a marketing intelligence product, designed to deliver at-scale information about advertisers, publishers, brands, and campaigns – from creatives and KPI performance to demographic data, interests, and behavioural insights.

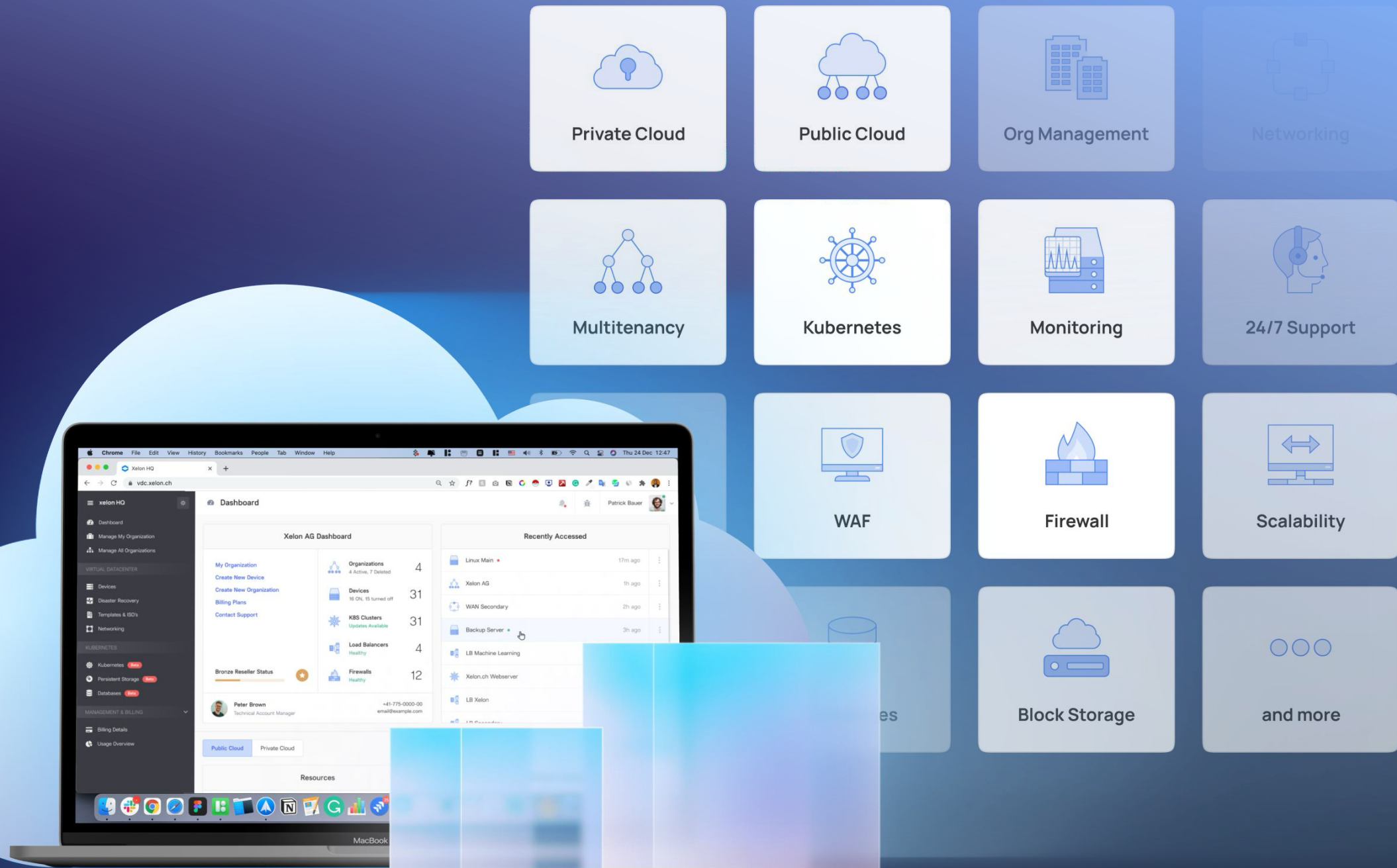
The product builds data on a 30M+ user panel, providing valuable inputs for world-leading companies.

The product integrates through partnerships (SemRush, Winmo), as well as its own environment for premium clients.

Solo Designer
role

2 years
cumulative project length

- Q2 2024
Platform redesign turned past declines into clients
- Q4 2024
New modules helped to land larger deals
- Q2 2025
Data Studio and Audience Insights add two more ways to work with data
- Q4 2025
Designed an AI chatbot and report processing to improve core offering



Xelon HQ cloud platform

Xelon HQ is a secure, hybrid cloud management platform.

Aimed at IT Service providers and SaaS companies, it allows running and managing cloud infrastructure in privacy-protected Switzerland.

Features, such as multitenancy, organization & user management, help to run and scale highly available server infrastructure, save costs, speed up the provision, and focus on customers instead of cables.

Role

Being the only designer was a challenge, but it helped to gradually grow my skillset around fast-paced problem-solving.

My transition into product management increased the impact on the product and opened more possibilities with the cross-functional team.

2018

Initial redesign, gaining first customers

2019

100+ companies are using the product

2020

Product becomes key item in Xelon portfolio

2021

Rapidly increasing customer acquisition

Xelon HQ Navigation

How internal card sorting helped us to clear up the navigation and tailor it for two key personas

Introduction

Xelon HQ is a web application for cloud infrastructure management.

Over time, we built more and more features, which were inflating the menu size. The question was, how to properly regroup the menu, so that it's smaller and still clear.

Customer Segments

We mainly target two customer segments – IT Service Providers and SaaS/Development Companies. The menu must make the key functionality easily accessible for both of these segments.

IT Service Providers

- provide the infrastructure to their customers
- expand service portfolio
- need org management & managerial features
- to cut costs and increase speed
- employ more managerial roles

SaaS/Development Companies

- need infrastructure mainly for themselves
- use a defined list of services
- need features to avoid supporting work:
 - monitoring, reports, snapshots, etc
- employ more technical roles

Objective

- Make the menu smaller, which would also impact the start of the learning curve
- Make sure key functionalities for both segments can be easily accessed
- Make sure menu items frequency is comparable across segments
(number of popular/less popular/least popular items must be comparable for two personas)

Prerequisites

At the start, we only had the data on menu clicks. It was enough to define a few menu items “to deal with”, but nothing about the way to do so and where to move those functions.

I’m a fan of the principle “If you can answer some of the questions with cheaper research, do it first”. Based on that thought, I decided to perform an internal card sorting with members of my team and see where it gets us.

Card sorting items

Our “too big of a menu” had 15 items in question (randomly sorted):

Current Plan	Kubernetes	Addon Library	All Networks
Home / Dashboard	Templates & ISOs	vDC Usage Overview	Persistent Storage
Manage All Organizations	Manage Billing Plans	Manage My Organization	Resource Usage Reports
Load Balancers	Firewalls	Devices	

The challenge of this card sorting was the number of participants. Having only 7 people was detrimental to statistical significance, so I had to do something. I could increase the number of participants, but at the time, it was only viable for the team members to participate.

With that in mind, I’ve decided to add another level of abstraction and introduce an additional step. After the participant had grouped the items, I asked if any of the items inside the groups could be merged or shown together. This added another set of “links” between some of the menu items and made the outputs a bit more tolerable.

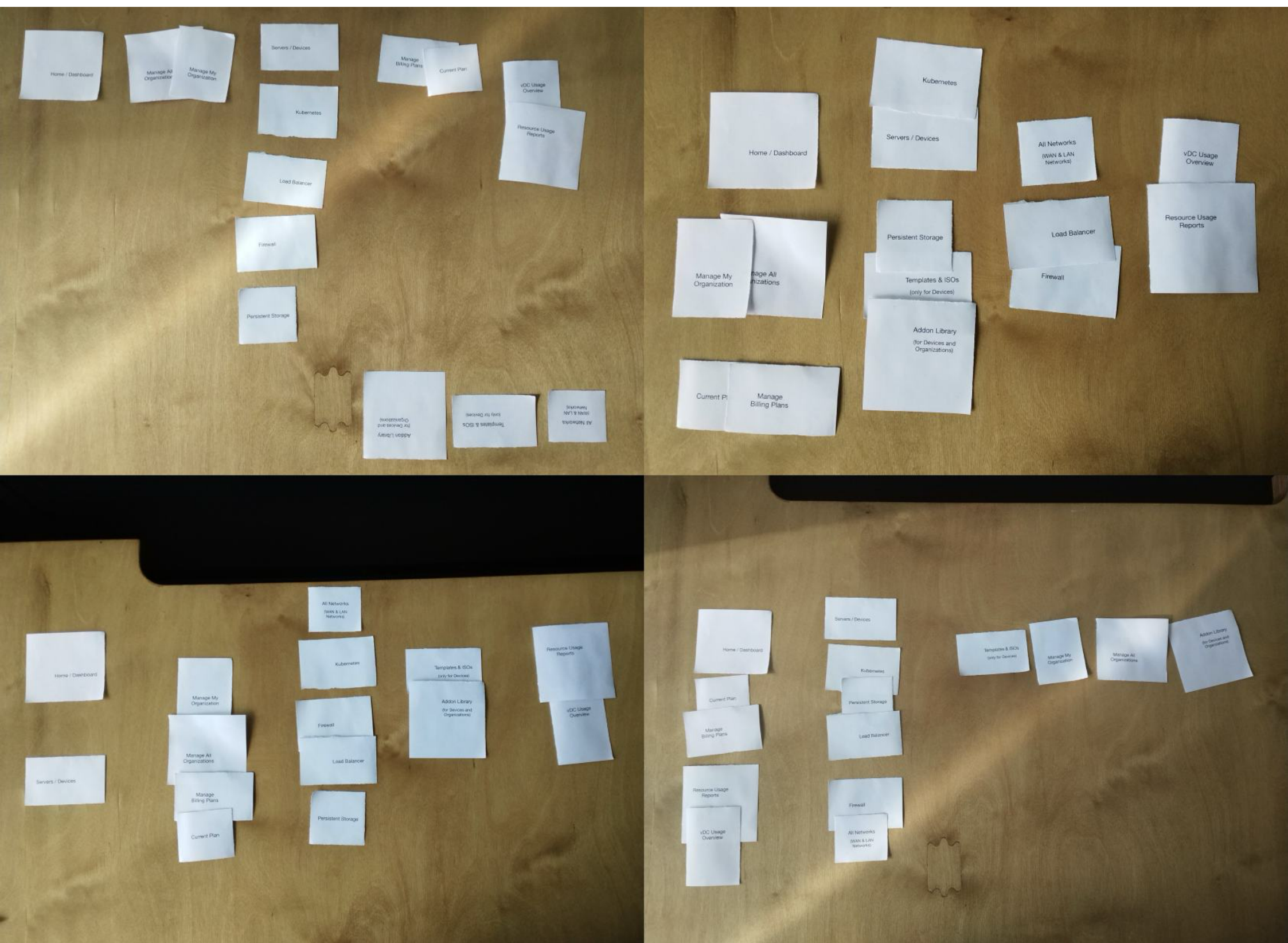
Interview tip

While moderating card sorts for navigation, ask participants if any of the items inside the groups could be merged or shown together.

Typical interview

For the moderated interview, I briefly talked to each participant and walked them through the following steps:

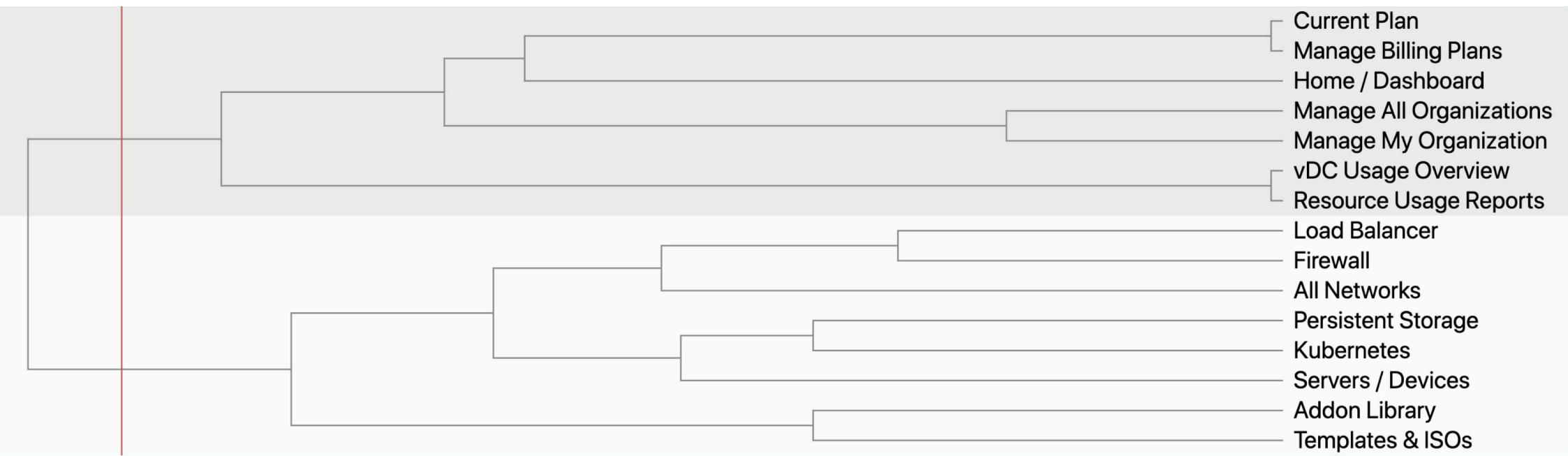
- 1. Before the start: short interview about general thoughts of current navigation, likes & dislikes
- 2. “Please, take a look at the cards and feel free to ask questions if some are unclear”
- 3. “Can you put the cards into groups by their theme or purpose? If there are some that you can’t put into a category, set them aside or rotate them”
- 4. Clarifying questions from both sides (most of the qualitative insights were found in this step)
- 5. “Can any of the items be merged or shown together? If so, please put them together”
- 6. Closing discussions



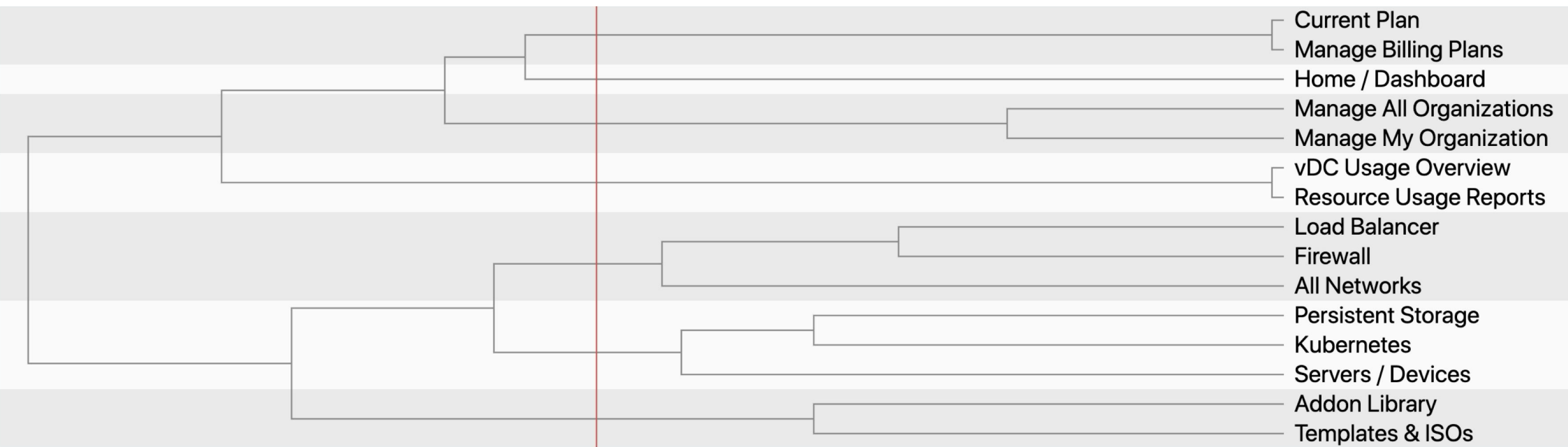
Some of the shots I made to document the process

Outputs

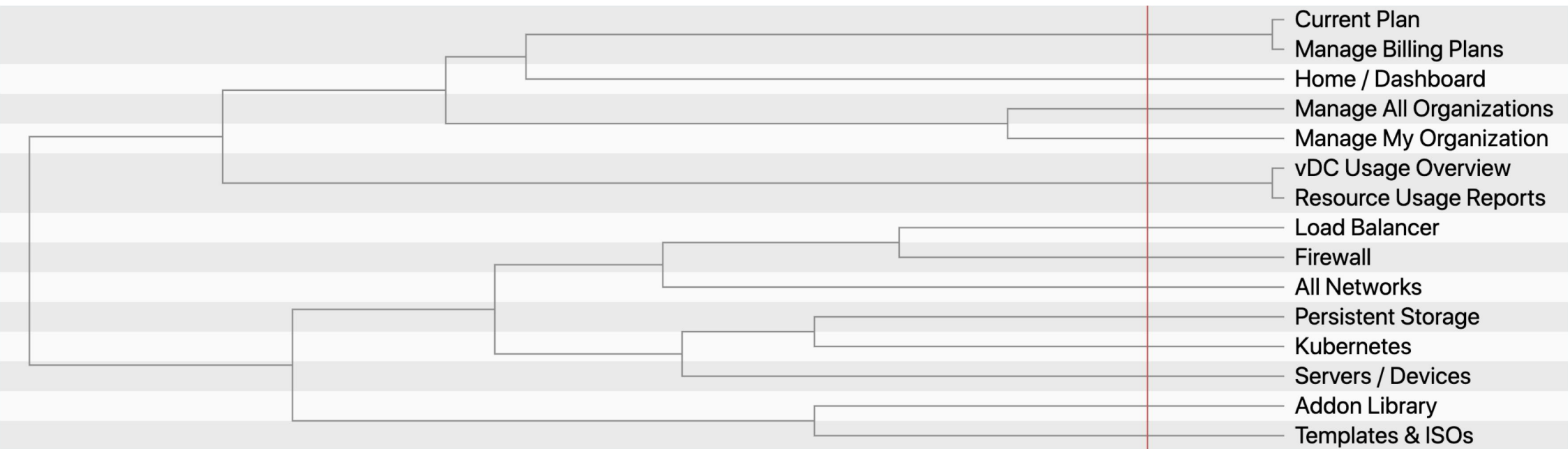
After some nitty-gritty transfer into a magic blackbox, it has produced the following dendrogram:



Top-level split: managerial/operational functionality



Mid-level split: functional groups



Bottom-level split: trivial groups

Did it work?

After seeing the outputs and having a few conversations, I decided to merge some of the items on the bottom- & mid-level splits:

- Current Plan + Manage Billing Plans = Billing Details
- vDC Usage Overview + Resource Usage Reports = Usage Overview
- All Networks + Load Balancer + Firewall = Networking

In a month or so, we also deprecated the “Addon Library” for its lack of use. And so, after this experiment, we ended with 10 menu items instead of 15 at the start.

How we measured results

All of our users are assigned to a specific company. Handily, this creates an interesting correlation:

- the more unique users & less unique organisations are interested in a feature - the more interesting it is for SaaS/Development Companies
- the more unique organisations are interested & the fewer unique users – the more interesting it is for IT Service Providers

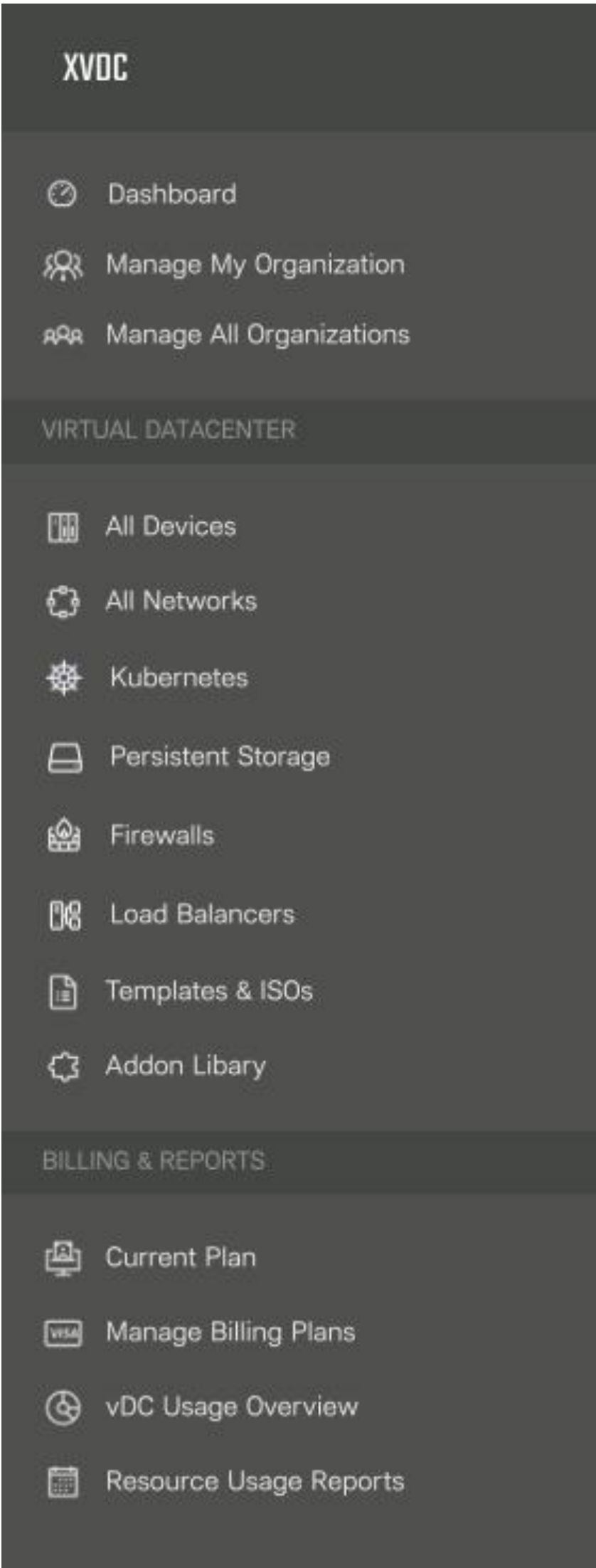
Over time, this correlation has helped us to confirm the menu differentiation by persona (won't mention the period of click records to protect the sensitive data):

Menu item	Users	Companies	Total clicks	Clicks/user	Clicks/org (scaled)	Delta	
Manage All Organizations	212	124	6450	30,42	33,38	1,10	More popular with IT Service Providers
Usage Overview	130	77	954	7,34	7,95	1,08	
Templates & ISO's	167	103	1175	7,04	7,32	1,04	
Manage My Organization	228	142	2861	12,55	12,93	1,03	
Dashboard	244	152	4418	18,11	18,65	1,03	
Devices	291	189	8997	30,92	30,55	0,99	More popular with Development/SaaS Companies
Networking	235	155	4798	20,42	19,86	0,97	
Kubernetes	147	101	2494	16,97	15,85	0,93	
Billing Details	181	126	988	5,46	5,03	0,92	
Persistent Storage	116	83	844	7,28	6,53	0,90	

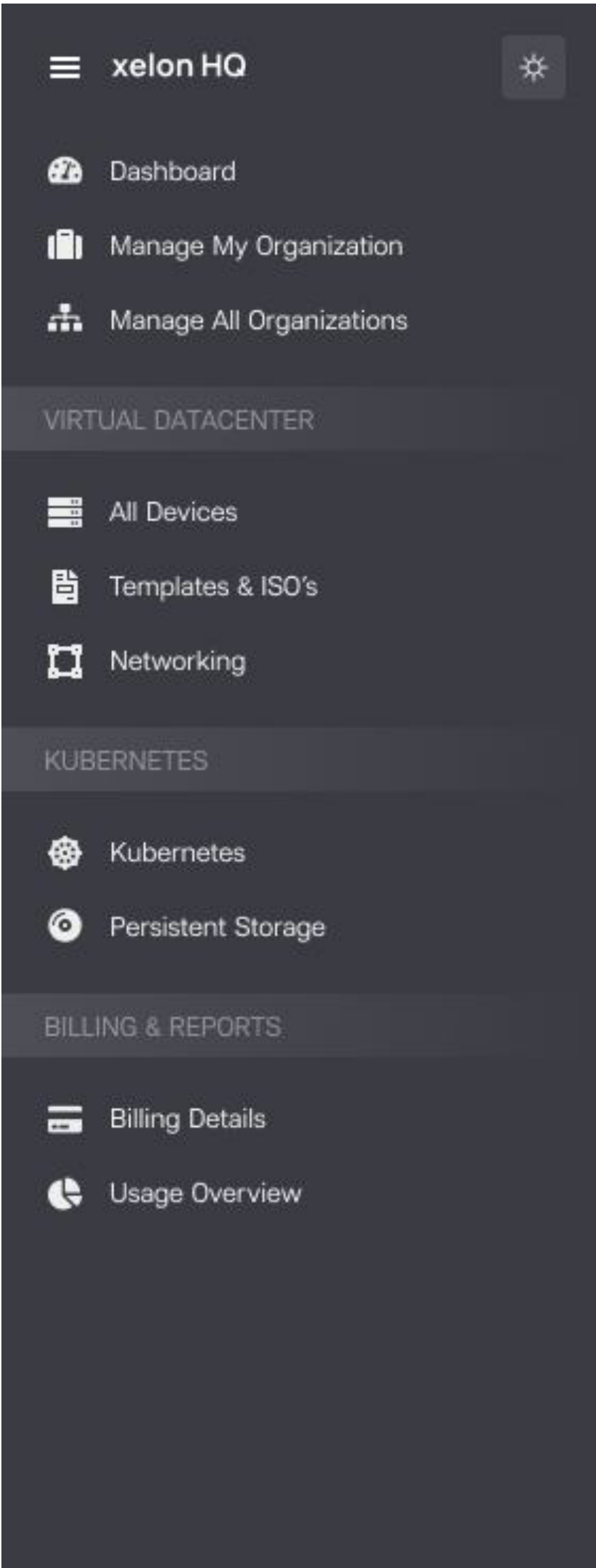
Objectives check-in

- ✓ Make the menu smaller, which would also impact the learning curve (15 items → 10 items)
- ✓ Make sure key functionalities for both segments can be easily accessed (nearly 50-50 split)
- ✓ Make sure menu items frequency is comparable across segments
 - (number of popular/less popular/least popular items must be comparable for two personas)

BEFORE



AFTER



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